

The Way I Cope

Everything that inspires me is what makes life worth living. All five words that I chose define me as a person, this is not a definition of me but more of an explanation of the things that have been there to shape me and make me who I am. After reflecting on the factors of influence that have defined me, I came up with these five things. My parents, My uncles, nature, music, and design. After reflecting on these influences I developed them into the motifs of brace, comedy, untamed, self-determination, and stunning. For me my parents have been my rock, they have been there for everything, and have kept me together on a path to success. Without them I'd be nowhere and the me of today would never exist. They are fundamentally the most important factors in my life that have ever influenced me. The word brace to me represents that rock, because for me my parents have always been my main source of support. I have always needed their support and I'm always going to be grateful for all of it. A brace isn't something that hinders you, it's a protective shell that helps you heal or grow. It's a way of keeping the bad of the world out, fundamentally it's an armor that for me I found in my parents.

My uncles were not always there but when they were I felt at home I felt safe and loved. They are both really funny and that was always something that I loved. Humor and comedy are important to me, I like to laugh and I like to smile so having them around helped with all of that. A lot of my own humor I get from both of them and my parents. But my uncles were different, they were somehow new but the same, they weren't as much of a protector but instead a friend. This connection gave me strength and brought me joy. Both my parents and my uncles define what I want in life, they are what I dream to become, and hope to be seen as.

Nature has always been there, it is beauty at its rawest. Earth's greatest creation. I have always felt the freedom of it all, the beauty that is untamed and wild, that instinctual connection to something more, something incredible. Nature is incredible and the feeling that it gives has given me inspiration and love for the world. It has made me wise and given me patience. I have always loved the outside world, the wild forests and rivers that flourish and bring life.

Everyone in my life that has ever inspired me has always had an affinity for music, and all of that led to my love for so much of the music I listen to today. It started with my parents. They would always play music, no matter what we did I always remember the music. Vinyl records were probably the most inspirational of them all, that tactile feeling and the crisp but raspy sound was beautiful, it connected me to the music at a deeper level than anything else could have. I remember being younger and never being allowed to touch my dad's records, this barrier made music even more desirable. The rules made me want what I couldn't have. I needed music. I was self-determined to discover more music that inspired me. The first time I ever started to experiment with music was on my mom's computer, that was where she had all of her albums downloaded. I remember spending hours listening to all of the songs, just discovering everything that I could. Passenger and Cat Stevens were probably the most inspirational at the time, they both had such beautiful and loving lyrics which made me need more. As I grew up, I continued to discover more and more music, leading to today where I'm always listening to music and always finding new artists that inspire me.

Design for me started with the home my grandma lived in, in New York. There was something stunning about it. There was art everywhere and all of the history associated with it was

incredible. Living in such a diverse cultural city also helped, New York City was a wonderful city to grow up in. We would constantly be going to the Guggenheim and countless other museums. I used to love museums and this love led to a dream of becoming an architect. Eventually that dream faded but it carried me through most of my life.

My mom was probably the most inspirational person when it came to design, she had always pushed me and my siblings to create, and I loved to create. I did everything from scratch, and it was all because of her. Eventually in California, when I was able to have my own room, I began to narrow down my creativity and part of that was when I was designing my room to look and feel like me. I made it perfect, it was my space, my sanctuary, and everything that inspired me helped me make it. My inspirations make up my soul, they help me survive and grow. They are the deepest part of me that defines who I am. I thrive in this world when I am creating, it makes me feel alive.